

vice for storing electricity and therefore a balance between power input to and output from the battery is extremely important for optimal performance and life of a battery.

VRLA batteries by design operate in a specific band of depth of discharge and require modulated charging, whereas conventional flooded batteries can work in a much broader discharge and charge regime. As such, the actual usage condition is the key factor in deciding the type of battery to be used. Simply speaking, VRLA batteries can work optimally in areas having low power cuts, whereas conventional flooded batteries are best suited for high-power-cut areas.

Going by the Indian consumers' habit, where nobody pays attention to maintenance, SMF VRLA batteries are a natural choice if the price



Exide's Powersafe batteries

is workable.

Major applications areas

It is very difficult to single out SMF VRLA battery applications as newer product applications are emerging every day. SMF batteries find use in telecom systems, UPS, inverters, emergency lights, big weighing machines,

solar systems, E-bikes and many other systems. At present, the largest user of these batteries is the telecom industry followed by UPS with solar applications catching up slowly.

UPS systems are used to provide backup power for computers and other critical instruments. The share of SMF VRLA batteries in the UPS sector is 80-85 per cent and the balance uses flooded tubular (both flat-plate and tubular-plate) batteries.

Types available

SMF batteries are of two types: AGM and gel. Of the two, AGM is growing the fastest.

If we go by the rated capacity, the classification would broadly fall into three segments:

1. Small: 3 Ah to 17 Ah
2. Medium: 26 Ah to 200 Ah
3. Large single cells: 2V 100 Ah to

With the rising production costs overseas, India is definitely a good destination if the right skills and the plate chemistry technologies can be mastered indigenously



—Praveen Kumar Sood, chairman, Regnart



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